Vietnam Q3 2026 GDP: who bought, who made the 9.95%, and who benefited

In Q3, output per worker rose about 8.5%, but real income rose only about 4.9%, and the VN-Index fell 4.91% in the same quarter. This summary starts from each component of GDP, opens up which sectors produced it, and shows where the money went, who benefited and what Q4 needs.

STANCE: DEFENSIVE, SELECTIVE | Probability of 12.5% in Q4: 15–20% | Full year central: about 9.6%

Q3 GDP	GROSS CAPITAL FORMATION (I)	NET EXPORTS (NX)
+9.95%	**+21.39%**	**-3.79 pts**
fastest since Q3/2022; 9 months +9.01%	adds 7.06 pts in Q3, the strongest component	exports +23.27% but imports +28.75%

INDUSTRY AND CONSTRUCTION	MANUFACTURING: OUTPUT VS VALUE ADDED	PRODUCTIVITY VS REAL INCOME
+12.50%	**+15.3% · +12.28%**	**+8.5% · +4.9%**
produced about 4.81 pts of the 9.95%	value added grows at about 80% of output	workers produce more, take home less

KEY CONCLUSION

Q3 growth of 9.95% is real and confirmed by both measures, but narrow: FDI factories, public-investment construction sites and inventories carry most of it, while mass consumption and workers' income lag. Full-year growth is most likely about 9.6%; the realistic ceiling is about 9.9–10%.

- C + G: household spending runs ahead of real income, financed by credit and asset prices; government consumption is nearly flat as the state apparatus is streamlined.
- I: the strongest engine, but about 1.9–2.8 pts are inventories and valuables; new capacity comes mainly from public investment and FDI plants.
- NX: record exports are largely assembly of imported components, so net exports subtract about 3.8 pts and the value retained in Vietnam is thin.
- Workers: real income grows at less than two thirds of productivity; the gap goes to depreciation and investors' profits, part of it to foreign parents, and part still sits in warehouses.

01 Three findings when both measures are combined

Finding	Spending side (who bought)	Production side (who made it)
Growth is concentrated in factories and construction sites	I +21.39%, X +23.27% vs final consumption +8.96%	Industry and construction about 4.81 pts; manufacturing alone about 3.2 pts

Finding	Spending side (who bought)	Production side (who made it)
Record exports, thin value retained	NX subtracts 3.79 pts (Q3), 4.22 pts (9M)	Manufacturing output +15.3% vs value added +12.28%; electronic components imports +71.7% to 188.9 bn USD (9M)
Part of growth sits in warehouses	I adds 7.06 pts; fixed assets explain only about 4 pts	Manufacturing inventories +11.9% y/y at end-September; September sales -0.5% m/m

OUR VIEW

- **The two measures tell the same story: growth is strong but narrower than last year, export value retained is thin, and part of output is still waiting for a buyer.**

02 One pie, cut two ways: contributions to Q3 growth (pts)

Spending side	Pts	Production side	Pts
Final consumption C + G	+7.40	Agriculture, forestry, fishery	+0.48
Gross capital formation I	+7.06	Industry and construction	+4.81
Net exports NX	-3.79	Services	+4.03
Statistical discrepancy	-0.72	Product taxes less subsidies	+0.63
GDP Q3	**9.95**	GDP Q3	**9.95**

OUR VIEW

- **Both sides add up to 9.95%. The 0.72 pt statistical discrepancy is within normal error, so the headline is credible.**
- International visitors' spending is counted in exports, not household consumption; retail sales are an indicator, not C.

03 Component by component: who buys, which sectors make it

Component	Growth	Contribution	Main producing sectors	Assessment
Household consumption C	9M +9.75%	+6.88 pts (9M, official)	Retail, food, accommodation; banking and housing services	Ahead of real income (+4.9%); funded by credit (+16.69% y/y) and asset prices
Government consumption G	9M +1.22%	about +0.15 pts (9M)	Public services	Spending restraint during the administrative streamlining
Gross capital formation I	Q3 +21.39%	+7.06 pts (Q3)	Construction +14.22%, machinery, inventories	About 1.9–2.8 pts are inventories and valuables
Exports X	Q3 +23.27%	part of NX	FDI makes 80.7% of goods exports; international visitors' spending counted here	Record, but driven by imported components
Imports M	Q3 +28.75%	NX -3.79 pts (Q3)	Electronic components +71.7%	Value retained in Vietnam is thin

OUR VIEW

- **Final consumption and investment explain the growth; net exports subtract from it because imports of components outpace exports.**

04 Who benefits from 9.95%

Measure	Value	Note
Labour productivity (Q3, TVN)	about +8.5%	GDP +9.95% vs employment +1.35%
Real income of workers	about +4.9%	less than two thirds of productivity
Employment, whole economy	+1.4%	September output +16.7%, industrial employment +3.4%
FDI profits repatriated	20–21 bn USD a year	about 4% of GDP: inside GDP but not retained
Inflation by income group (9M)	4.9% vs 4.1%	low-income vs high-income households
Farm income	5.4 m VND a month	about half of services (10.9 m VND)

OUR VIEW

- **Workers: real income grows at less than two thirds of productivity; the gap goes to depreciation and investors' profits, part of it to foreign parents, and part still sits in warehouses.**
- Household spending (9M +9.75%) runs at about twice real income: part of today's purchasing power is borrowed from tomorrow's income, so consumption is unlikely to carry Q4.

05 Q4 and full year: one set of scenarios, checked two ways

Scenario	Probability	Built by component: Q4 · year	Checked by sector: Q4 · year	Conclusion
Central	55%	11–11.5% · 9.6–9.7%	11.24% · 9.63%	Q4 about 11–11.5%, full year about 9.6%
Upside	20%	12–12.5% · 9.9–10%	12.25% · 9.91%	Hits the production ceiling, full year about 9.9%
Downside	25%	9.5–10% · 9.2–9.3%	9.96% · 9.27%	Orders fall, full year about 9.2–9.3%
Ceiling		I must grow 31–32% to reach 12.5%	12.3% · 9.9%	Realistic 2026 ceiling about 9.9–10%

OUR VIEW

- **To reach 10% for the year, Q4 must grow about 12.5%, 2.55 pts above Q3, while the largest jump in the past three years was 1.25 pts.**
- The production ceiling is a central estimate with an error band of about ±0.3 pt, so 10% requires every sector to slightly exceed its ceiling at once: probability 15–20%.

06 What would prove our conclusions wrong

Conclusion we use	Indicator	Release	Threshold that breaks it	If hit
Orders still support FDI factories	October PMI (S&P Global)	02/11/2026	PMI below 50 or export orders fall a 3rd month	Downside to about 35–40%

Conclusion we use	Indicator	Release	Threshold that breaks it	If hit
Part of the 9.95% sits in inventories (1.9–2.8 pts)	Manufacturing inventories, sales	06/11/2026	Inventories below +8%, sales above +15% y/y	Smaller inventory risk; tilt upside
Public investment is the main Q4 engine	Budget capital spending, Oct	06/11/2026	Below 100 trillion VND in the month	Tilt downside
Mass purchasing power is weak	Real retail sales, CPI	06/11 and 06/12	Real retail above 10% two months, CPI below 4.5%	Tilt upside
Inflation does not yet force rate hikes	CPI y/y, Oct and Nov	06/11 and 06/12	Above 5.5% two months in a row	Tighter money; lower I and valuations
Stay defensive on equities	Overnight rate, central FX rate	Daily	Overnight below 4%, central rate below +2% YTD, two weeks	Raise equity weight earlier
Full year about 9.6%, 10% unlikely	Q4 and full-year GDP	06/01/2027	Q4 above 12.3%, beyond the ceiling	Revisit assumptions

SIGNALS TO WATCH

- **The three most important thresholds all report in the first week of November: the PMI on 2 November, then budget capital spending and manufacturing inventories on 6 November.**

07 Investor implications

Market indicator	Latest	Note
VN-Index, Q3	**-4.91%**	1,860.01 to 1,768.62 points
Market earnings, Q3 (MBS forecast)	**+25% y/y**	valuations compressed as the index fell
10-year government bond yield	**about 4.59%**	up about 0.5 pt in a month
Foreign investors, week 28/9–02/10	**net sell 4,945.7 bn VND on HOSE**	after the Fed hike and a stronger USD

OUR VIEW

- **The market prices financial conditions and growth quality, not the growth rate: higher bond yields and FX risk make each unit of earnings worth less.**
- Where the market misprices: valuations are compressing across the board, yet sectors tied to public investment (ports, logistics, steel, materials) have real orders, while sectors relying on mass purchasing power and mortgage credit face slow real income and 14–16% mortgage rates.

Ticker	Action	Entry	Target	Stop	Horizon	Macro thesis	Risk
GMD	Buy	74–78	88	71	Q4	Trade turnover 9M +30.4%; above MA200	Slower global trade, lower freight
HPG	Buy	19.5–20.5	23.5	18.8	Q4	Q4 public investment 1.8–2x quarterly average	Slow disbursement, downtrend
BSR	Hold	Above 29	35	27.5	1–2 months	Brent around 102 USD	Oil falls if tensions ease
CTG	Hold	28.8–30	34	27.8	Q4	Credit +16.69% y/y	Margin squeeze
MWG	Hold	70–74	82	67	Q4	Final consumption Q3 +8.96%	Weak purchasing power if CPI stays high
KBC	Stay out	Wait above 27	–	–	–	FDI registered +76.4%; below MA200	High rates, land legal issues
VCG	Stay out	Wait above 15.2	–	–	–	Public investment play; -28% since 30/6	Strong downtrend

Prepared by TVN & Partners from official data cited in the full Vietnamese report (General Statistics Office 03/10/2026, State Bank of Vietnam, S&P Global, HOSE). Contributions, weights, productivity, inventory estimates, scenarios and probabilities are TVN estimates. Stock prices as of the close on 02/10/2026. For information only; not an offer or solicitation to buy or sell securities.

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